

Figure 1: Adding a mesh cube

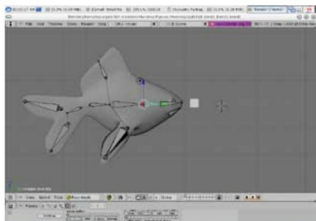


Figure 2: Scaling down the cube

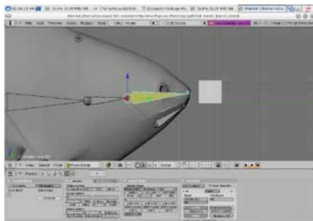


Figure 3: Adding IK control to the head

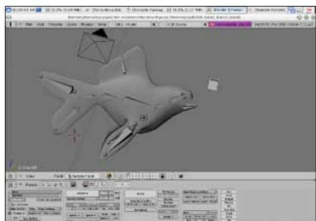


Figure 4: Moving the cube to observe deformation

remove extra weights and add weight where necessary. On the weight painting slider, the lower part is for lower values and the upper part for higher values.

Creating keyframes for animation

Shift to the Animation UI through the drop-down menu. Select the whole armature at Frame 1. Press 'I' for a pop-up menu to key in various attributes. Key the location, rotation and scale on the first frame. Selecting the armature and controls, move the goldfish forward in the viewport. Shift to frame 250 and key the frame (press 'I' and key the location, rotation and scale). Shifting back to Frame 1, test your animation—press **Alt+A** to play it. You will observe that the goldfish moves forward and the animation loops. Figures 8 and 9 show the insertion of keyframes at 1 and 250. Figure 10 shows the goldfish playing as a loop in the camera view.

Path animation: a good way to animate simple objects

The easiest and the most convincing method of animating simple objects is path animation. It can create both the simplest and the most complex animation, depending on the type of path you create. In Blender, you first create your object, and then your path, after which you parent the object to the path

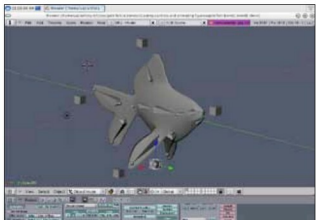


Figure 5: Creating four control cubes

using the *Follow Path* command, which could be done in various ways. Once your object starts to follow the path, the animation can be fine-tuned in various ways (modify the path's attributes, or modify the IPO curves in the Curve Editor).

Creating circular motion

While at the Animation UI, press **Add** to add a nurbs circle. Press **F9** to go to the buttons for nurbs and surface attributes.